Last Minute Courier

High Concept | v0.8 | November 8, 2026

High concept statement

A campus movie night is missing its coffee, projector lens and final reel. As the last courier on shift, you borrow three seconds from blue-tagged machinery to find safe crossing and boarding windows, deliver all three parcels, and earn a seat at the screening.

Player role and primary gameplay

You control one courier in a connected 3D campus, using an avatar-based interaction model and a dynamic third-person camera. This is a single-player action and timing puzzle game: observe a moving device, choose a path, then sprint, jump, climb or slide through a safe window, and deliver. Movement borrows from parkour games: a held sprint, a slide under anything low, an automatic climb when a jump meets a ledge, and forgiving jump timing. The camera follows without head bob, shake or motion blur; it widens slightly at a sprint. Mouse control, gentle recentering, optional direction lock, sensitivity and field-of-view controls support different preferences.

Audience

For players who understand a keyboard and mouse but may be new to 3D action games. Three short opening cards (story, ability, key-cap controls) and an untimed practice yard precede the first deadline. Wide paths, nearby recovery points and longer alternative paths support cautious players; lifts, stepping stones, crate walls, rolling shutters, turnstiles, a shuttle, a market roof and a springboard offer more demanding routes. English is the default, with Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Spanish, French and German available from a language selector. Translation coverage is checked; native-speaker review is pending.

Distinctive experience

The Borrower slows marked machinery to one quarter speed for up to three seconds, a few times per delivery (3, 4, then 5 uses, counted beside the Q key). It leaves the courier and deadline unchanged, so extending a safe window still costs delivery time. Releasing it after boarding makes transport useful again. One rule supports avoidance, boarding and route planning, and it meets the parkour moves at the rolling shutters (slow the door so a slide fits) and turnstiles (slow the arms to jump one and slide under the other). Each parcel has its own concern: the coffee cools, the lens case cracks after three knocks, and the reel must beat the screening. Gold hourglasses and lines of gold sparks on the bolder lines give Q extra uses, close calls earn more sparks, and each delivery is rated 1-3 stars by its concern, so a finished run is worth replaying.

Each parcel changes the same evening: coffee brings warm cups and a musical layer; the lens prepares the projector and brings an audience; the reel opens the cinema. Three delivery stamps become one admission ticket. The courier contributes to a shared event and receives a place in it.

World and progression

A small, stylized campus connects a parcel desk, coffee plaza, garden, projection booth and clocktower cinema. Cream buildings, terracotta details, blue clock tags and orange route markers make roles recognizable. Read the story, practice movement/jumping/time control, then complete coffee, lens and reel orders in sequence. Read each untimed brief before accepting its deadline. A collision or fall returns to a nearby checkpoint; an order retry preserves earlier deliveries. Completion reveals the screening and offers Play Again.

Modes, platform and scope

One local single-player campaign; no multiplayer, competitive mode or separate time-trial mode. Timed delivery is the primary gameplay mode; untimed practice and collection are preparation modes. Story, briefing, pause/help, results, timeout and completion are shell screens. Target releases are Windows x86-family, macOS and Linux x86-family; exact Windows/Linux bitness must be confirmed if the instructor means 32-bit specifically. Mac is the current development and validation platform.

One complete level is implemented. The target first completed run is 5-10 minutes without filler. A real-speed autoplay using only player controls reached the ending in 3:00 from the first story card (Nov 7, v0.5.4). It already knows every route, so this is an expert lower bound and does not establish first-time player duration. Genuine first-time timing, learning transfer, enjoyment and comfort remain acceptance checks.

Course structure checked against lecture deck 3, slides 19-23, 35, 47, 55 and 80-82. Monetary and licensed-IP pitches are omitted as permitted for this class. No minimum hardware specification is claimed without independent build tests.